HACK876 × JN FOUNDATION

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Innovation is a must. Let's start it early.

The JN Foundation names innovation as a guiding principle. Hack876 gives secondary-school students one day to build their first idea, and a JN award would tell them it matters.

Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)



80	9	1
STUDENTS	SCHOOL NETWORK	DAY

One day to build something that should exist.

01 WHAT IS HACK876?

Meet Hack876.



Hack876 is a one-day build competition for approximately **80 secondary-school students** from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4, roughly 20 teams in all, on Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative).

Teams pick a real problem, use modern tools including AI, get guidance from mentors, and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges. It is not a school assignment and there is no answer key.

Our **9-school network** in Kingston is made up of the schools where the Hack876 team currently has relationships and can coordinate most reliably. It is not an exclusive eligibility list.

BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

Youth, education and innovation, in one room.

Hack876 is where a secondary-school student first turns an idea into something that works, with technology and a team beside them.

JN FOUNDATION MISSION

“The JN Foundation works with internal and external partners to identify, develop and provide technical and financial support to projects and programmes that focus on issues relating to rural development, health, housing, education, youth, community, crime and safety.”[2]

"Innovation is a must" is one of the JN Foundation's four guiding principles, and its mantra begins "Innovating, Inspiring, Impacting".[2]

In 2023, the "Building Future FinTech Innovators: Skills for Life" camp drew about 300 participants and focused on "careers and other opportunities in tech".[3]

Science Genius Jamaica, with Columbia University's Professor Christopher Emdin, used dancehall to get high-school students and teachers excited about science.[4]

The JN scholarship programme began 43 years ago and now adds summer camps, leadership workshops and a new mentorship programme.[5]

In September 2026, young Jamaicans spent time with JN Group professionals, including Information Technology staff, alongside the US-based Valda Mae Care Foundation.[6]

Young people, culture and tech.

CULTURE MEETS STEM

Science Genius Jamaica

Dancehall lyric-writing as a way into high-school science, ending in the B.A.T.T.L.E.S. finals in July 2017.[4]

TECH CAREERS

Building Future FinTech Innovators

A 2023 camp of about 300 participants, with speakers from Microsoft, JN Bank and JN Group cyber security.[3]

43 YEARS

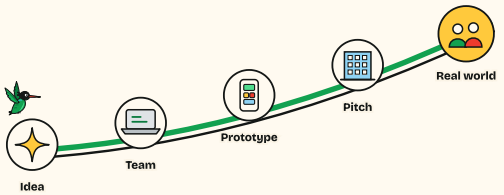
JN Scholars

Scholarships plus summer camps, leadership and financial literacy workshops, and a new mentorship programme.[5]

2026

NextGen leaders at JN

Young people met JN Group CEO Earl Jarrett and teams across the Group, from IT to Business Strategy.[6]



The JN Foundation already brings culture, technology and careers to young Jamaicans. Hack876 is a place for them to build.

04 THE SCHOOL NETWORK

9 schools. One room.

Hack876 begins with the schools where we already have relationships and can coordinate most reliably for the inaugural staging. Formal confirmations are still in progress, and the network is not an exclusive eligibility list.

- Hillel Academy
- Campion College
- Jamaica College
- Immaculate Conception High School
- Wolmer's
- Ardenne High School
- American International School of Kingston
- St. Andrew High School for Girls
- St. George's College

There are two natural homes for this inside the JN Foundation.

Sydoney Preddie leads Youth and Education Programmes at the JN Foundation, and would be a natural colleague to include.[7]

FOUNDATION

A JN special award

- Contribute toward a special award
- A proposed JN Innovation Award, if it fits
- Presented on stage by the JN Foundation team
- Small, specific and easy to report on

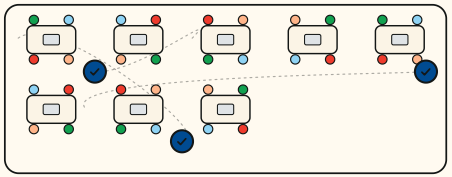
PEOPLE

JN people in the room

- IT, cyber security and fintech staff as mentors
- A short talk on technology careers, with JN's introduction
- Volunteers for check-in and the day's logistics

The JN Foundation's contribution does not have to be purely financial.

People in the room.



01
Mentors

Technologists and security people who help teams get unstuck, without building the project for them.

02
Award presenters

The JN Foundation team presents its award on stage at the close.

03
Speaker

A short, honest talk on building a career in technology, from someone JN would like to introduce.

04
Judging support

The JN Foundation can advise on the award criteria; the final call sits with the judging panel.

05
Volunteers

Staff and JN Circle members, if the Foundation wishes, who help with check-in, meals and keeping the day on time.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

No marketing of bank accounts, loans, insurance or other financial products to students, and no sign-ups on the day.

No collection of student contact details or data by sponsors. Photos and names only with school and parent consent.

Sponsor staff mentor and present; the judging panel decides every award.

Become a Bronze Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

BRONZE PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876

It turns "Innovation is a must" into something a student can win, and it is a small, clear commitment that is easy to report on.

Any amount within the level is welcome. It is a flexible contribution toward the event, with no naming rights attached.

PROPOSED RECOGNITION

JN Foundation

Bronze Partner · Inaugural Hack876

Closest Hack876 tracks: Culture, Business, Learn, Resilience

CONTRIBUTION LEVELS. ANY AMOUNT WITHIN A LEVEL IS WELCOME.

Bronze Partner	Silver Partner	Gold Partner	Platinum Partner
SUGGESTED			
J$50,000 to below J$200,000	J$200,000 to below J$500,000	J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000	J$1,000,000+

In-kind & Community Support: devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and contributions below J$50,000.

08 CONTRIBUTION LEVELS

What each level receives.

Bronze Partner

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

OUR SUGGESTION

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

Silver Partner

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

Gold Partner

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement
- A dedicated sponsor feature
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

Platinum Partner

J$1,000,000+

- The most prominent sponsor placement
- An agreed opportunity to take part in the programme
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

Speaking, mentoring, presenting an award and judging are subject to suitability and programme capacity. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

09 WHERE A CONTRIBUTION GOES

No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

WHAT A CONTRIBUTION COULD SUPPORT

- **Special awards.** Helps support an existing special award.
- **Programming.** Helps support mentoring, judging and the student programme.

A sponsor can support the event overall, or agree a specific use with the Hack876 team. No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

In-kind & Community Support

For devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and for contributions below J$50,000.

A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

AN IDEA, NOT YET A HACK876 AWARD

JN Innovation Award (proposed)

A suggestion only: an award for the boldest, most original build, in the spirit of "Innovation is a must". A Culture-track version, echoing Science Genius Jamaica, could work too. Criteria would be agreed together, and the judging panel would decide.

10 A DIRECT LINE

There is no faceless sponsorship process here.

This proposal is for **Claudine Allen, General Manager, JN Foundation**.[1]

If the JN Foundation is interested, we can decide together what involvement should actually look like.

QUESTIONS WE WOULD ANSWER TOGETHER

- ✓ Is this a grant, and who would receive the funds?
- ✓ How does this fit our youth, education and innovation priorities?
- ✓ Which schools and students take part?
- ✓ When and where is it?
- ✓ How are students protected on consent, data and marketing?
- ✓ How much staff time would mentoring or judging support take?

A conversation, not a workload.

Deliberately focused.

Our vision is national. This inaugural staging does not have national-event resources, and we will not pretend it does.

Approximately 80 students. A school network of 9 in Kingston. One day, done properly.

Build the first one well.
Learn from it.
Earn the right to make the second one bigger.

2027

Help make the first Hack876 happen.

No multi-year commitment required.

FUTURE POSSIBILITIES, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

- A recurring JN Innovation Award at every Hack876.
- A Hack876-style challenge inside the JN Scholars summer camp.
- A Culture and code challenge in the spirit of Science Genius Jamaica.
- JN professionals as mentors through the year, alongside the new scholar mentorship programme.



HACK876 × JN FOUNDATION

Somewhere in that room may be a future founder, engineer, designer or leader.

They do not need us to decide who they become.

They need an opportunity to begin.

HELP US BUILD THAT OPPORTUNITY.

We would love to explore the right first step with Claudine and the JN Foundation team.

Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)

hack876.com info@hack876.com

SOURCES

1. JN Foundation, "Claudine Allen, General Manager (profile)." www.jnfoundation.com/claudine-allen/
2. JN Foundation, "About Us (mission, vision, guiding principles, mantra)." www.jnfoundation.com/about-us/
3. JN Foundation, "AI in Fintech Can Address Financial Inclusion, Claudine Allen (August 14, 2023)." www.jnfoundation.com/ai-in-fintech-can-address-financial-inclusion-claudine-allen/
4. JN Foundation, "Science Genius Jamaica." www.jnfoundation.com/science-genius-jamaica/
5. JN Foundation, "JN Foundation Opens Applications for 2026 PEP Scholarships and Grants (July 13, 2026)." www.jnfoundation.com/jn-foundation-opens-applications-for-2026-pep-scholarships-and-grants/
6. JN Foundation, "NextGen Leaders Gain Firsthand Lessons from JN Group Professionals (September 30, 2026)." www.jnfoundation.com/nextgen-leaders-gain-firsthand-lessons-from-jn-group-professionals/
7. JN Foundation, "Our Team." www.jnfoundation.com/our-team/

A private partnership proposal prepared for Claudine Allen, General Manager, JN Foundation.